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DJIA 46121.28 ▼ 171.50 0.37% NASDAQ 22497.86 ▼ 0.3% STOXX 600 553.88 ▼ 0.2% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 7/32, yield 4.145% OIL \$64.99 ▲ \$1.58 GOLD \$3,732.10 ▼ \$48.50 EURO \$1.1739 YEN 148.90

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A pickup in dealmaking** and IPOs is spurring big banks to accelerate the hiring of more staff and slow layoffs that they might otherwise have made. **A1**
- ◆ **Delta Air Lines** is replacing power units on more than 300 of its Airbus jets in an effort to stem cases in which toxic fumes have leaked into the air supply. **A1**
- ◆ **A second-straight slide** in tech stocks dragged major U.S. indexes down again, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both losing 0.3% and the Dow falling 0.4%. **B10**
- ◆ **Nearly 6.3 million people** tuned in to watch Jimmy Kimmel's return to the air after his show was suspended over remarks he made about the killing of activist Charlie Kirk. **B1**
- ◆ **Alibaba shares jumped** after the company said it would invest more than \$53 billion in artificial intelligence and released a new model. **B4**
- ◆ **Lithium Americas** is in talks with the Energy Department and GM over terms of its \$2.26 billion government loan for a project to mine the metal in Nevada. **B2**
- ◆ **The SEC accused** two men who bought well-known brands out of bankruptcy of running a Ponzi scheme that raised about \$112 million from investors. **B2**
- ◆ **KB Home recorded** lower fiscal third-quarter profit and lowered its full-year outlook as a dormant housing market forces home builders to make price concessions. **B3**
- ◆ **Ridgmont Equity Partners** said it raised nearly \$4 billion for its latest fund to buy U.S. midmarket companies. **B6**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump told leaders** of Arab and Muslim-majority countries that he would pressure Israel not to annex parts of the West Bank and to back a U.S. plan to end the war in Gaza. **A6**
- ◆ **Israel closed the** Allenby Bridge border crossing between Jordan and the Israeli-controlled West Bank, further isolating the territory. **A6**
- ◆ **Israel's military said** Houthi militants in Yemen launched a drone attack that hit a hotel in the southern Israeli city of Eilat, causing several casualties. **A6**
- ◆ **A person detained** by Immigration and Customs Enforcement was killed and two others were critically injured when a shooter opened fire at an ICE field office in Dallas. **A3**
- ◆ **Justice Department** officials are racing to obtain criminal charges this week against former FBI Director James Comey, escalating Trump's unprecedented efforts to prosecute his political foes. **A3**
- ◆ **The White House's** budget office directed federal agencies to draw up plans to permanently reduce their workforces if there is a government shutdown next week. **A2**
- ◆ **The U.S. and its allies** are developing versions of Iran's low-cost, long-range Shahed delta-wing drone, which has proved effective at overwhelming air defenses. **A7**
- ◆ **Chinese leader Xi Jinping** took an indirect jab at Trump and criticized countries that are turning away from the fight against global warming as he presented a new plan to cut greenhouse-gas emissions under the Paris accord. **A7**

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Deadly Typhoon Ragasa Slams Into Hong Kong



LAM KYI BLOMBERG NEWS

POWERFUL BLOW: Typhoon Ragasa, one of Asia's strongest storms in years, made landfall on the southern China coast Wednesday, bringing tall waves and heavy rain and winds. The storm has killed at least 27 in Taiwan and the Philippines. **A6**

Zelensky's Charm Offensive Reverses Trump's Skepticism

Ukraine's president polishes his praise, spruces up attire to improve relationship

By JAMES MARSON
AND JANE LYTUVYNENKO

KYIV, Ukraine— Six months ago in the Oval Office, President Trump told President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine that “you don’t have the cards” in the war with Russia. This week at the United Na-

tions, Trump lauded the performance of Ukraine’s army and poured scorn on Russia’s military efforts.

“I think Ukraine, with the support of the European Union, is in a position to fight and WIN all of Ukraine back in its original form,” Trump wrote on Truth Social after meeting with Zelensky. “Why not?”

The sharp verbal shift from Trump came amid Moscow’s continued failure to make significant gains on the battlefield, a slowdown in the Russian economy and a concerted

effort by Zelensky to woo the U.S. president.

Addressing the U.N. General Assembly on Wednesday, Zelensky didn’t comment on Trump’s apparent change of tack, saying only that he had a “good meeting” with him. He urged representatives of member nations to condemn Russia as it “keeps dragging this war on.” He also warned that if left unchecked, Moscow would widen its ambitions. “Ukraine is only the first, and now Russian drones are already flying across Europe, and Russian

operations are already spreading across countries.”

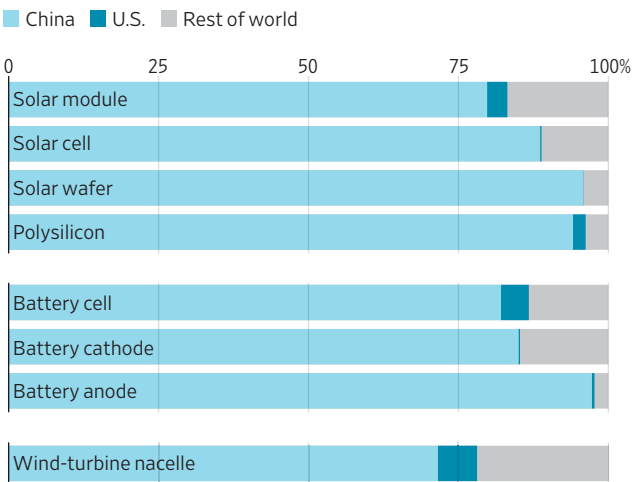
Trump has spent recent days with U.S. officials who have long pushed for a stronger stance toward Ukraine as he prepared for the meeting with Zelensky, including Ukraine envoy Keith Kellogg and the U.S.’s new ambassador to the U.N., Mike Waltz. They updated Trump on battlefield conditions, according to two people familiar with the situation, noting that Russia has made little progress in recent years.

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China's Clean-Energy Reign

As Trump doubles down on fossil fuels, the U.S. has given up its effort to challenge China in renewable-energy industries. **A2**

Global share of clean-energy manufacturing*



*Data as of 2024
Source: BloombergNEF

A Courier Who's Always on Time Becomes a New York City Legend

Mamadou's myth grows with each delivery; 'I waited by the window' for him

By JULIA MUNSLow

Whispers of a seemingly superhuman delivery courier began spreading this summer. People said he is the hardest-working man in New York City. That he delivers your food faster than anyone else. That his orders always arrive at the exact requested location before he disappears into the wind, leaving behind only a bag of piping hot food.

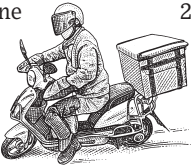
They claim that he is everywhere and nowhere at once. He is the man who, alone, shoulders the burden of keeping the city running. And he doesn't just deliver food, he delivers babies, too. His name is Mamadou. Dozens of New Yorkers have posted videos and

screenshots boasting that Mamadou has delivered their food and wondering how one man manages to do it all. They express their love and appreciation, sometimes with songs.

"He is the hero of our town," said Jake Schroeder, a 23-year-old Brooklynite. "It's giving the Michael Phelps of food delivery. He is what Kelly Clarkson was to American Idol."

"I waited by the window [for him]," said Clare Thomas Allen, a 28-year-old who lives in Manhattan's Upper West Side. "He should be the president," said Ben Weiss, a 24-year-old in the Flatiron district.

There's just one problem: Please turn to page A10



Urban legend

Delta Replaces Engine Units To Address Toxic-Fume Surge

By BENJAMIN KATZ

Delta Air Lines is replacing power units on more than 300 of its Airbus jets in an effort to stem cases in which toxic fumes have leaked into the air supply and led to health and safety risks for passengers and crew.

The move is one of the most aggressive efforts by a major U.S. airline to address what in recent years has increasingly become a hidden hazard of modern air travel.

The airline is about 90% of its way through the process of upgrading the engines, a type known as the auxiliary power unit, on each of its Airbus A320 family jets, according to

a spokesman for Delta. The airline operates 310 of the narrow-body type, including 76 of the latest generation models as of the end of June.

The APU is typically a third engine that sits in the tail of an aircraft and is used to generate electricity and pump air into the cockpit and cabin when the two primary engines aren't running, for example during taxiing. A leak in the APU can also contaminate the air even when it isn't in use, according to maintenance specialists and internal troubleshooting documents.

Airbus has previously identified the APU and how it is integrated on the A320 as a

leading cause of toxic fumes contaminating the so-called bleed air system. A fume event typically occurs when oil leaks into the engine or power unit's compression chamber and is vaporized at extreme heats, releasing unknown quantities of neurotoxins and other chemicals into the cockpit and cabin air.

The Wall Street Journal reported earlier this month that fume events have been surging in recent years, driven in large part by incidents on the Airbus A320 family, and that they have led to brain injuries and other illnesses in both crew and passengers.

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL

A closer look at leucovorin, the drug Trump is touting to treat autism. **A10**



BUSINESS & FINANCE

Ford courts riskier borrowers with lower rates for F-150 pickups. **B1**

Catholics Confront Manpower Problem

Fixing an accelerating clergy crisis won't be easy, but 'God continues to call'

VENEGONO, Italy—One of Pope Leo XIV's biggest quandaries is a question God himself asked: Whom shall I send? As in the book of Isaiah, few are answering "Here I am."

By David Luhnow,
Margherita Stancati
and Jon Emont

The Catholic Church has a manpower problem, and it's getting worse.

A sharp, decadelong decline in the number of young men who want to become priests has only accelerated since the pandemic. The lure of other career options and a growing wariness about a lifelong—and celibate—commitment is leading Catholics

to turn away from a once honored path, even in the faithful global South.

"We live in a culture caught in the paralysis of endless options, where choosing one path feels like closing the door on countless others," said Pietro Ferrera, a 30-year-old seminarian in Italy who has a degree in physics. It has had a cascading effect.

Since 1970, the global Catholic population has doubled, but the number of priests has dipped. As aging clergy die, the ranks of those waiting to take their place has dwindled, leaving some parishes with no leader. Seminaries are closing or merging across the Church's

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